



Media and Digital Literacy

For everyone...everyday



Which Platforms Out Of These Do You Use?

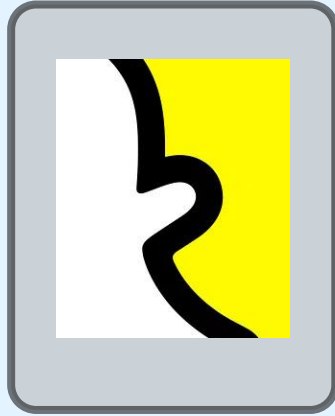
Before we begin... a quick game.

Let's see how well you know the digital world around you.



Which Platforms Out Of These Do You Use?

- Social platform known for disappearing messages
- Famous for streaks
- Uses AR filters extensively



- Launched in 2010
- Known for photos, reels, and stories
- Users often say "Link in bio"

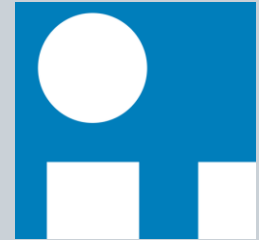


Which Platforms Out Of These Do You Use?

- AI platform
- Famous for generating text, ideas, and answers
- Became one of the fastest-growing apps in history



- Professional networking platform
- Used for resumes and job hunting
- Users often post career updates



Which Platforms Out Of These Do You Use?

- Social media platform
- Users post in communities called "subs"
- Upvotes and downvotes determine visibility



- It comes pre-installed on many Windows computers.
- It can work inside apps like Word, Excel, and PowerPoint.



Which Platforms Out Of These Do You Use?

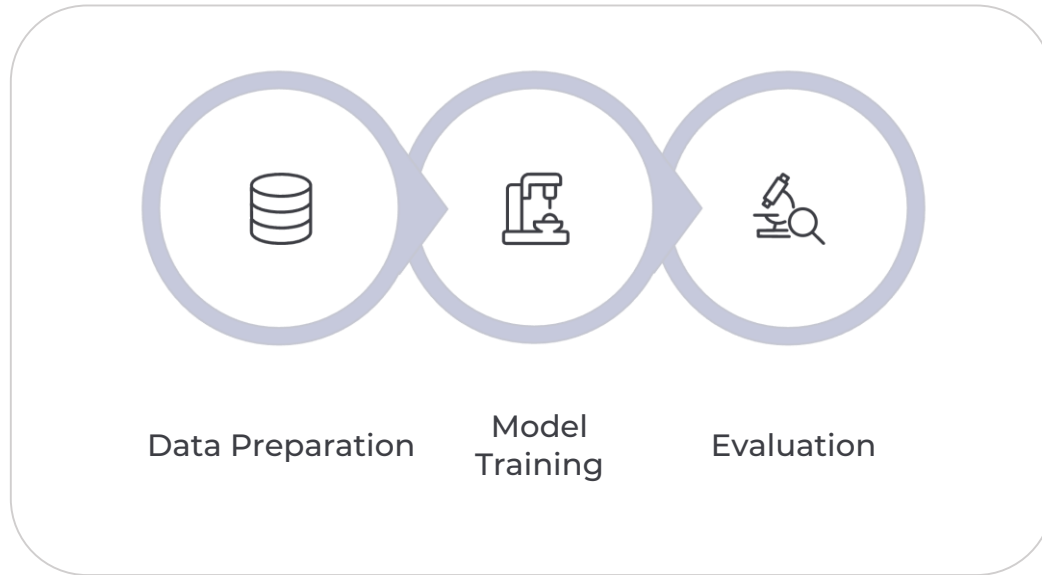
- Users can create their own communities called "servers."
- Gamers made it popular, but now students, creators, and businesses use it too.



Which of these platforms use AI to recommend content to you?

- Instagram
- TikTok
- YouTube
- Snapchat
- LinkedIn

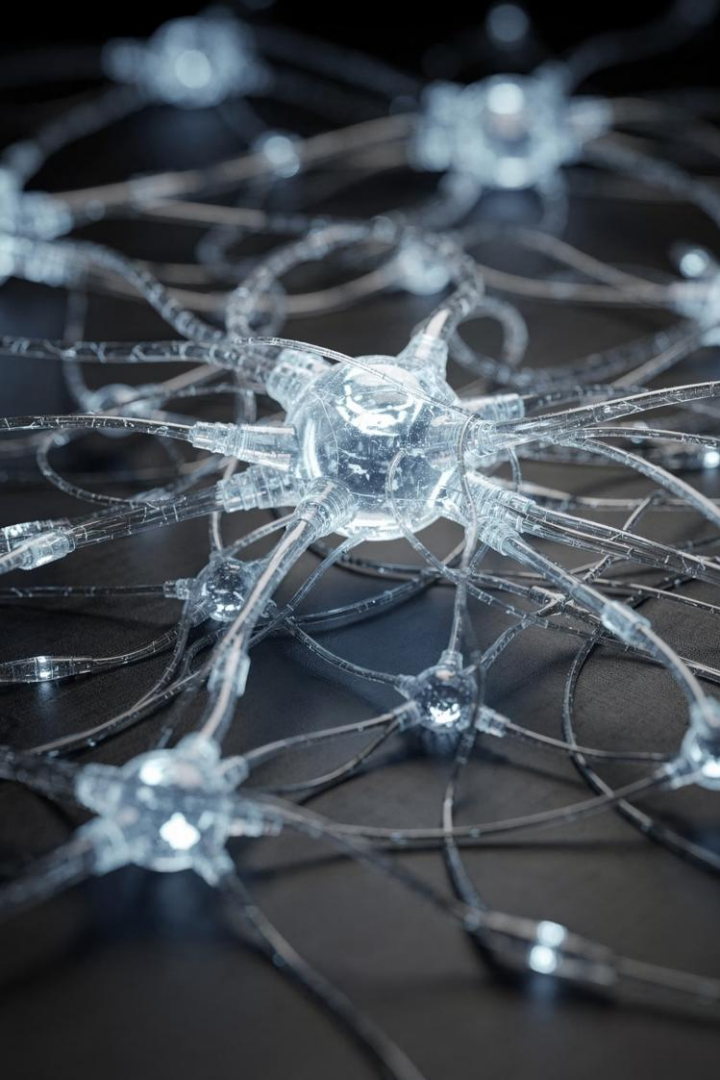
How AI Works — Simply Put



At its core, AI is a pattern recognizing machine

It learns from millions of examples, finds patterns, and uses them to make decisions with minimal human involvement.

 Think of it like teaching a child to recognise a cat by showing thousands of cat pictures.



The AI Family Tree

1

Machine Learning

Learns from data, improves over time

2

Neural Networks

Brain-inspired connected nodes; enables deep learning

3

Computer Vision

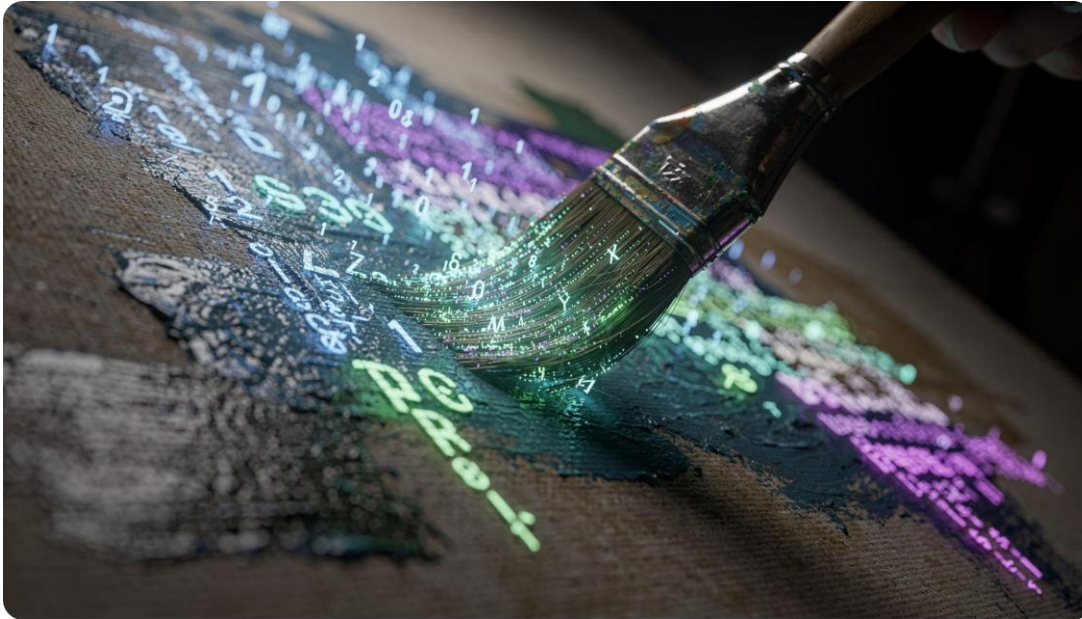
Machines that see face ID, self-driving cars

4

NLP

Machines that understand language like chatbots, translation machines

Generative AI & LLMs



Generative AI

AI that **creates** not just analyses. Text, images, code, music. Tools like ChatGPT and DALL-E.

Large Language Models (LLMs)

Trained on vast text data. They write, summarise, translate, and reason. Increasingly **multimodal** like text, image, audio.

- ❏ LLMs can even develop "emergent abilities" solving problems they were never explicitly taught.

AI Agents : AI That Acts



Plan

Break big goals into steps



Reason

Make decisions at each step



Act

Interact with digital or physical environments



Learn

Improve from experience over time

Unlike a basic chatbot, an AI agent pursues goals autonomously; this is called **Agentic AI**.

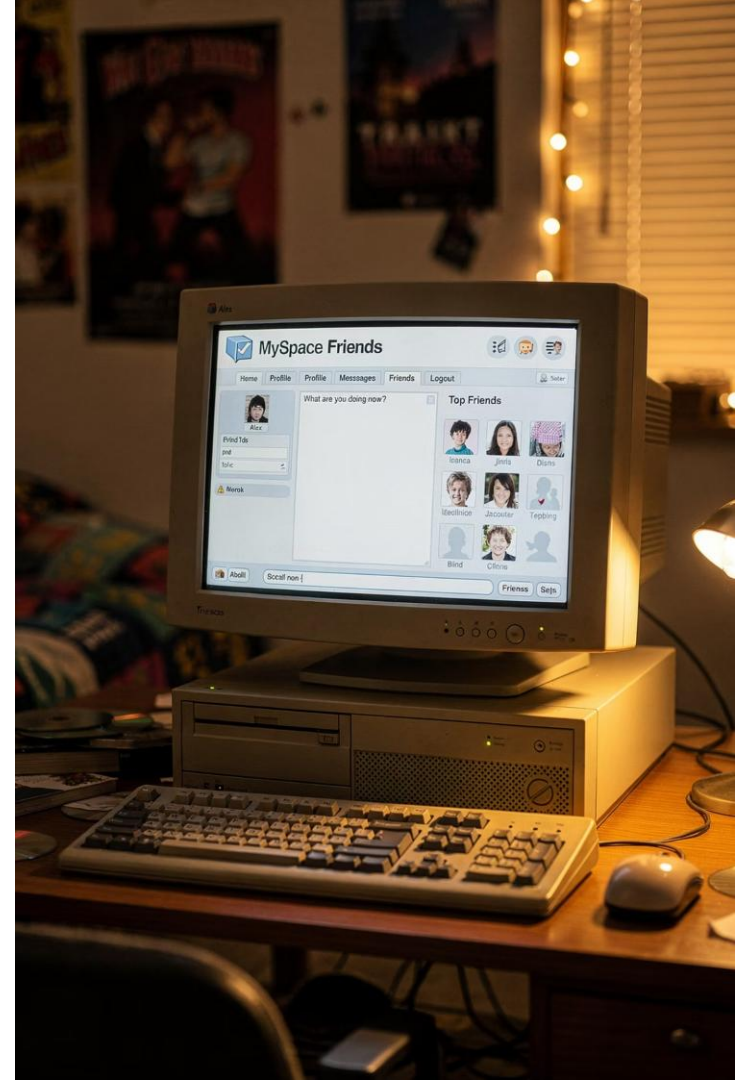


THE BUSINESS MODEL

Early 2000s: The Original Vision

Connect people. Grow the user base. Serve a few ads. Change the world.

Platforms like Friendster and early Facebook were built on an idealistic promise bridge distances, bring people closer.



THE BUSINESS MODEL

Today: The Attention Economy

Then

Meaningful connections, simple ads, community building

Now

Minutes spent. Posts viewed.
Ads served. **Engagement above all else.**



Success is no longer measured in connection; it is measured in **time stolen from your day.**



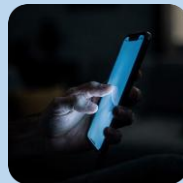
The Engagement Toolkit

How platforms keep you hooked by design.



Push Notifications

Constant nudges that pull you back in



Infinite Scroll

No natural stopping point...ever



AI Personalisation

Feeds tuned to your deepest preferences



Extreme Content

Outrage and shock drive higher engagement



Incentivised Use

Streaks, badges, and rewards for daily return

THE GOOD & THE BAD

Social Media: The Bright Side



Global Village

Instant connection across continents and cultures



Cultural Exchange

Exposure to ideas, art, and perspectives worldwide



Social Connections

Maintain relationships across distance and time



Amplified Voice

Ordinary people can reach extraordinary audiences





THE GOOD & THE BAD

Social Media: The Dark Side

Echo Chambers

Only hearing what you already believe

Polarisation

Us vs them... amplified by algorithms

Attention Hacking

Your focus, hijacked by design

Mental Health Impact

Anxiety, comparison culture, addiction

AI: Immense Promise



→ Speed & Efficiency

Processes in seconds what takes humans days

→ Automation

Frees humans from repetitive, mundane tasks

→ Personalisation

Tailored experiences at scale

→ Accelerated R&D

Drug discovery, climate science, engineering breakthroughs



THE GOOD & THE BAD

AI: The Serious Concerns

Cognitive Atrophy

Over-reliance weakens our capacity to think independently

Hallucinations & Bias

AI can confidently fabricate facts or perpetuate prejudice

Environmental Cost

Massive energy and water consumption for training large models

The Black Box

Even creators can't always explain why AI made a decision

Short-Term: Fight Tech With Tech



Take Back Control of Your Feed

- ☐ Set daily screen time limits
- ☐ Mark content as "Not Interested"
- ☐ Enable sleep mode & notification schedules
- ☐ Use content preference settings to shape your algorithm

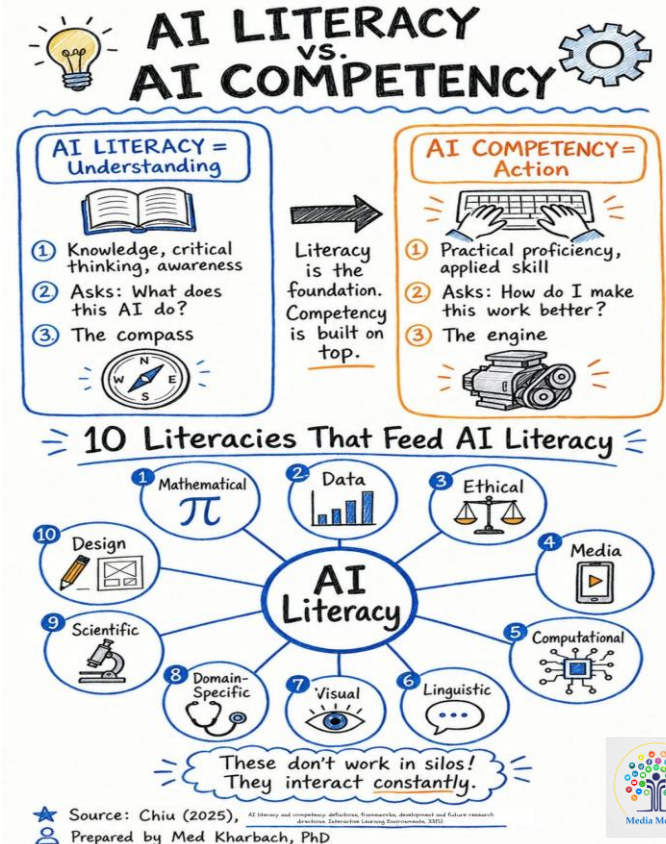
Using AI as a Thinking Partner

Tools for Thought

Microsoft Research's **Tools for Thought** project explores how AI can *augment* human reasoning...not replace it.

The goal: use AI to help you think **better**, not to think **for** you.

- ✓ Ask AI to challenge your assumptions, not just confirm them.



LONG-TERM SOLUTION

Media Literacy: A Way of Living

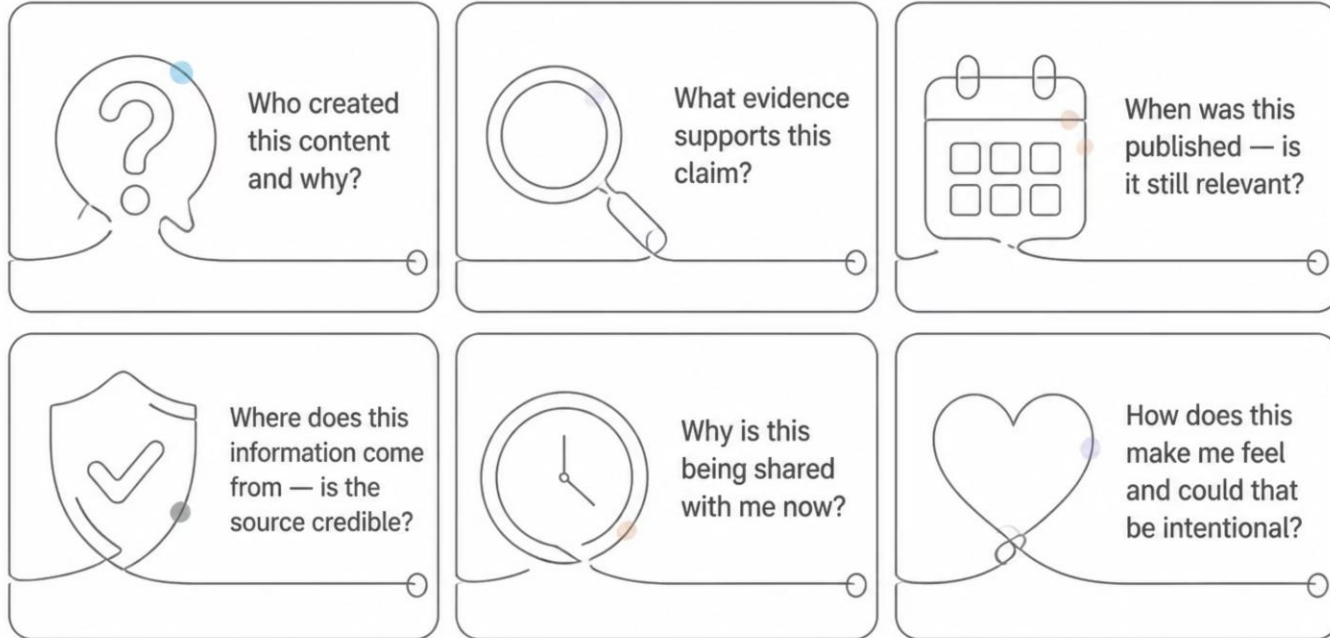
It's not just about understanding media, it's about living intelligently within a media-saturated world.

Access	Analyse	Evaluate
Create	Act Responsibly	



The 5Ws & 1H Framework

Apply this to every piece of content you consume or share.



Habits of an AI-Literate Person



Guard Your Privacy

Review permissions, limit data sharing, use strong passwords



Share Thoughtfully

Pause before you post or forward. Does this inform or inflame?



Verify Before You Trust

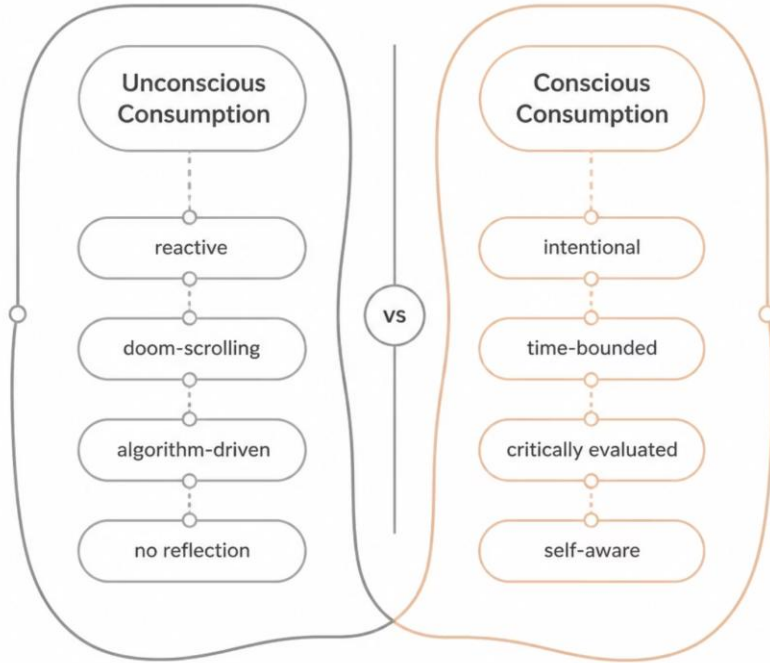
Cross-check sources. Scepticism is a superpower.



Think About Your Thinking

Metacognition: catch your own biases and reactions

Conscious Consumption



The Shift That Changes Everything

Increasing your **metacognitive awareness**:

knowing what you're consuming and why is the most powerful tool you have.

You cannot completely control what platforms serve you. You **can** control how you respond to it.



The goal isn't to quit media. It's to use it, not be used by it.



The Takeaway

AI is powerful

Understand it...don't fear it or
blindly trust it

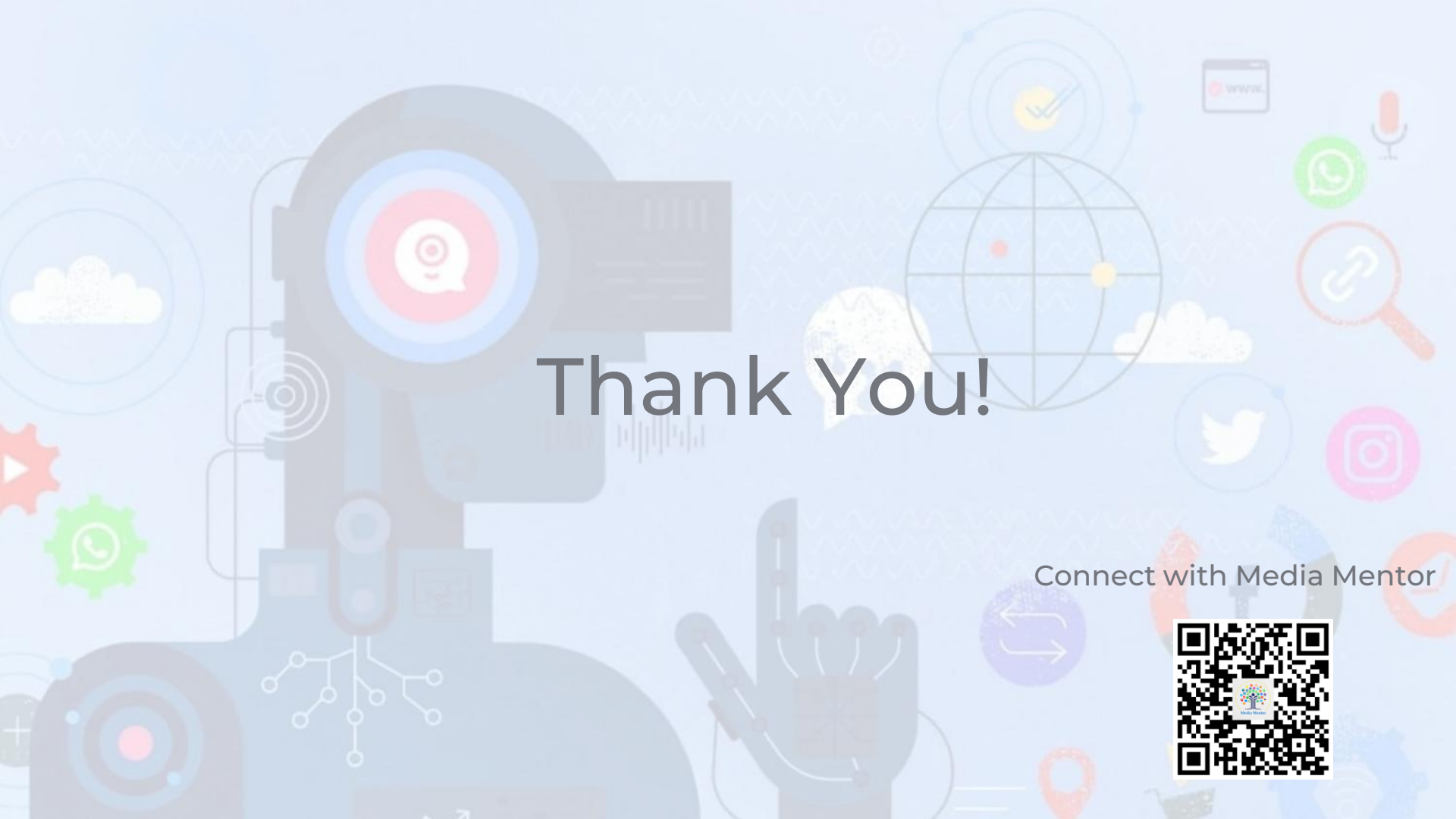
SM Platforms are designed to capture you

Know the tools they use. Take
back control.

Media and Digital Literacy is a life skill

Access. Analyse. Evaluate. Create. Reflect. Act.

In a world of infinite content, the most desirable act is being an
informed and responsible Digital Citizen.



Thank You!

Connect with Media Mentor

